



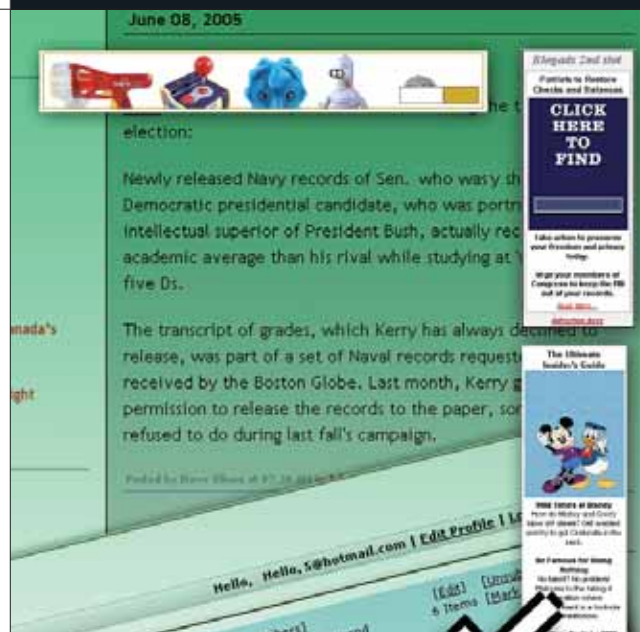
C V S Sharma
GM and Country Head,
Tribal DDB India

We have advertised on blogs to some extent. For instance, advertising campaigns for MSN and Reliance Mutual Fund were extended to blogs. We don't contact the blog publishers directly, and most of the ads are done through Google AdSense.

Indian blogs are still at the evolutionary stage. Abroad, blogs have almost 50 million hits per month, whereas in India the figure is just around 3,000 to 4,000 hits per month.

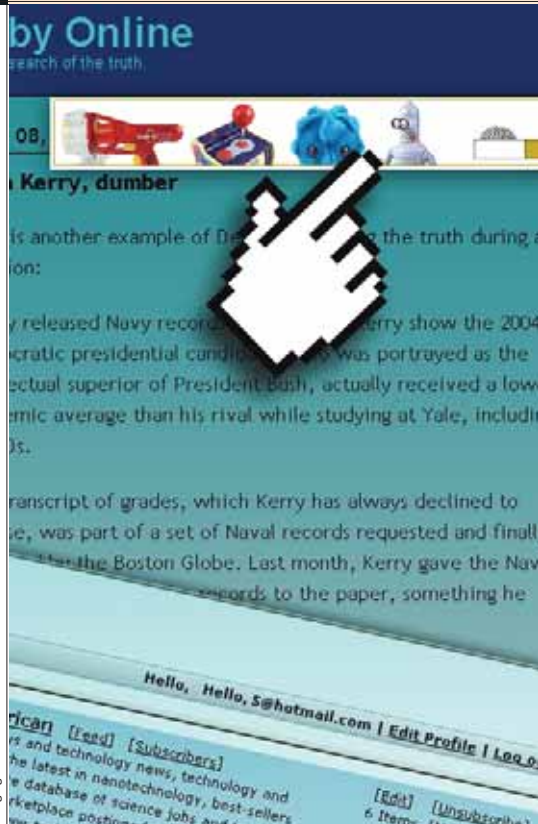
Although the current revenue from advertising on blogs is negligible, this segment can't be ignored. The focus on blogs is entirely content-oriented. Blogs are also a good example of two-way communication.

The viewer response to advertising on blogs would be higher than the traditional medium. In blogs, the ads will be looked at by serious surfers. As bloggers are increasing in number, India is slowly and surely catching up! In the future, newspapers may source content from blogs only because of the quality.



BLOGVERTISING,

With blogs becoming a rage, can they be the next hot-spot for advertisements?
Digit speaks to some people in the know



Sunil Miranda
Vice-president,
Mediaturf

Advertising on blogs hasn't taken off in India the way it has in the West. Indian advertisers are very reluctant to put their money into blogs right now. Also, if you were to compare the number of page views of an Indian blog to a US blog, it is much lower.

I would say the main reason blogs are not that popular is due to a lack of awareness among the general public. If you were to compare, people in India took considerably longer to adapt to e-mails than did their European counterparts. Similarly, in due course of time, when the market matures, blogs in India will see more action.

Earnings from blogs form a very small part of the revenue today. However, I am sure this will change in the future. While blogs have the advantage of being able to connect to the right people, they also have the constraint of not being able to reach remote audiences. Here, the traditional medium still has an edge.